

# CFO business-case pack

Contact Center AI Routing

Tenant: Apex Retail

Tenant key: apex-retail

Move ref: apex:move:contact-center-ai-routing

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A one-document CFO pack — the seven-part answer standard: the answer, the case, the assumptions, what would make it wrong, what not to fund yet, what Tower will measure, the evidence and gaps.

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# CFO business-case pack — the seven-part answer

Contact Center AI Routing · apex-retail. This pack answers the CFO question to the spec §9 standard: not just an answer, but the case, the assumptions, the failure modes, the funding hold, the measurement handoff and the evidence.

## 1 · Here is the answer

Verdict: SHAPE — do not fund as-is

The critic raised 1 blocker(s) — fund only once they are resolved. Re-shape the Move to close them.

## 2 · Here is the business case

|                          |                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Investment (effort)      | \$1,873,179 – \$3,085,236 (base \$2,203,740)                                                                             |
| Net value (post-haircut) | \$8,282,820 – \$14,335,650 (base \$11,309,235)                                                                           |
| Net return               | \$5,197,584 – \$12,462,471 (base \$9,105,495)                                                                            |
| Payback                  | Not monetisable — the value rests on a baseline seed gap, so the kernel returns no payback rather than a fabricated one. |
| Monetisable              | No                                                                                                                       |
| AI-build effort          | \$1,694,000                                                                                                              |
| Business-change effort   | \$509,740 (23% of effort)                                                                                                |

| Scenario     | Investment  | Net return   | ROI                     |
|--------------|-------------|--------------|-------------------------|
| Base         | \$2,203,740 | \$9,105,495  | Not recorded — seed gap |
| Conservative | \$3,085,236 | \$5,197,584  | Not recorded — seed gap |
| Upside       | \$1,873,179 | \$12,462,471 | Not recorded — seed gap |

Downside read: The conservative case cannot be expressed in hard dollars — the value rests on a seed-gap proxy. Close the baseline gap before reading the downside as a number.

### 3 · Here are the assumptions driving it

The three flagged TOP MOVERS move roughly 80% of the outcome.

- [TOP MOVER] [SEED-GAP PROXY] annual\_contact\_volume — Annual agent-handled contact volume is ~9.0M (benchmark for an \$80B retailer) — used only to express value in operational hours. (owner Priya Iyer (Program Lead); confidence low; impact high)
- [TOP MOVER] [SEED-GAP PROXY] cost\_per\_contact — Fully-loaded cost per contact is ~\$6.50 (benchmark proxy) until the tenant baseline due 2026-05-15 lands. (owner Brendan Fox (CS Ops); confidence low; impact high)
- [TOP MOVER] containment\_uplift — AI routing lifts containment ~12 points (28% ' 40% target) — the KPI dictionary states this uplift target explicitly. (owner Priya Iyer (Program Lead); confidence medium; impact high)
- adoption\_ramp — Customer Care agents reach 70% steady-state adoption by year 2; the WFM lead is on record preferring agent-assist over IVR replacement. (owner Mariana Rojas (WFM Lead); confidence medium; impact medium)
- privacy\_gate\_clears — The transcript-use privacy review (2026-05-17 milestone) clears without scope cuts that remove agent-assist features. (owner Elena Fischer (AI Governance); confidence medium; impact medium)
- rate\_card — Blended delivery rate card reflects market rates for AI build and integration roles. (owner David Okafor (Program Lead); confidence medium; impact low)

### 4 · Here is what would make me wrong

The case breaks if the baseline seed gap is not closed — without the missing unit economics the value range is a proxy, not a forecast.

- [blocker/cfo] cfo\_monetisation\_blocked: Value cannot be monetised to a hard dollar figure — the gross value range rests on a seed-gap proxy. The CFO will not approve a fabricated return; the case must close the baseline gap first.
- [concern/data] data\_baseline\_seed\_gaps: 4 baseline metric(s) are seed gaps (coverage 60%): Cost per contact (labour), Annual contact volume, Channel mix (voice/chat/IVR split), QA error rate. The case is grounded only on what is recorded.
- [concern/data] data\_top\_mover\_is\_proxy: 2 of the top-3 case-moving assumptions stand in for absent tenant data (annual\_contact\_volume, cost\_per\_contact). Validating these is the highest-leverage next step.

### 5 · Here is what I would not fund until fixed

- kill\_downside\_negative: Net return is negative in the conservative case (5197584). Kill or re-shape if the downside cannot be lifted above zero.
- kill\_monetisation\_unresolved: The baseline seed gap that blocks monetisation is not closed before the gate — without it the return is unverifiable.
- kill\_baseline\_unclosed: Baseline coverage stays below acceptable level — 4 seed gap(s) remain unresolved at the gate.
- kill\_privacy\_gate\_blocks: The 2026-05-17 transcript-use privacy review fails and removes agent-assist features — the value case loses its core mechanism.

Surfaced structural flags:

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[critic/blocker] Value cannot be monetised to a hard dollar figure — the gross value range rests on a seed-gap proxy. The CFO will not approve a fabricated return; the case must close the baseline gap first.

- [critic/concern] 4 baseline metric(s) are seed gaps (coverage 60%): Cost per contact (labour), Annual contact volume, Channel mix (voice/chat/IVR split), QA error rate. The case is grounded only on what is recorded.
- [critic/concern] 2 of the top-3 case-moving assumptions stand in for absent tenant data (annual\_contact\_volume, cost\_per\_contact). Validating these is the highest-leverage next step.

6 · Here is what Tower will measure later

3 of 4 metric(s) are wired to a recorded baseline (coverage 75%). Value loop closes: NO.

| Metric                     | Baseline                | Target                  | Cadence   |
|----------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------|-----------|
| Contact Center Containment | 28                      | 40                      | monthly   |
| Average Handle Time        | 7.2                     | 6.5                     | monthly   |
| CSAT (post-interaction)    | 4.1                     | 4.4                     | quarterly |
| Cost per contact (labour)  | Not recorded — seed gap | Not recorded — seed gap | monthly   |

7 · Here is the evidence I used — and what is missing

Baseline coverage 60%. 6 recorded metric(s), each with a cited source:

| Metric                             | Value                   | Source                                                | Quality         |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Average Handle Time                | 7.2 minutes             | KPI kpi:apex:019 (NICE CXone)                         | measured/high   |
| Contact Center Containment         | 28 percent              | KPI kpi:apex:018 (NICE CXone)                         | measured/medium |
| First Call Resolution              | 68 percent              | KPI kpi:apex:020 (NICE CXone)                         | measured/medium |
| Agent Utilization                  | 84 percent              | KPI kpi:apex:021 (NICE CXone)                         | measured/high   |
| CSAT (post-interaction)            | 4.1 score_out_of_5      | KPI kpi:apex:012 (Zendesk survey)                     | measured/medium |
| Repeat transfer rate               | 18.4 percent            | Move P2 baseline deliverable (Genesys routing export) | measured/medium |
| Cost per contact (labour)          | Not recorded — seed gap | seed gap                                              | absent/low      |
| Annual contact volume              | Not recorded — seed gap | seed gap                                              | absent/low      |
| Channel mix (voice/chat/IVR split) | Not recorded — seed gap | seed gap                                              | absent/low      |
| QA error rate                      | Not recorded — seed gap | seed gap                                              | absent/low      |

Declared seed gaps — missing, never invented:

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Cost per contact (labour): Not recorded. Tenant action item "Capture cost-per-contact baseline" (owner Brendan Fox) is due 2026-05-15 — see operating telemetry.

- Annual contact volume: Not recorded in the KPI dictionary, telemetry, or the Move baseline. Needed to convert AHT/containment deltas into FTE-hours and dollars.
- Channel mix (voice/chat/IVR split): Containment note references "IVR + chatbot" but no structured split is seeded.
- QA error rate: No contact-centre quality-defect metric is seeded for Apex.

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